

HALF

1. Passage anchor

> “I remember she told me, ****half joking and half serious****, that I was now old enough to ‘write my own story.’”

Passage meaning

****half**** = partly; to some extent, but not completely

****半是..... ; 有點..... ; 一半..... 一半.....****

Here:

> ****half joking and half serious****

= ****半開玩笑、半認真****

The speaker means the sister was joking to some extent, but also genuinely meant what she said.

Practice

1. He was ****half joking**** when he said he wanted to quit.
他說想辭職時是****半開玩笑的****。

2. She gave me a ****half-serious**** warning.
她半認真地警告了我一下。

Core quantity meaning

2. half — one of two equal parts

= one of two equal parts of something

****一半 ; 二分之一****

Examples

1. I ate ****half**** of the cake.
我吃了蛋糕的****一半****。

2. ****Half**** of the students were absent.
****一半****學生缺席。

This is the central numerical meaning.

3. half of something

= one of two equal parts of a whole

.....的一半

Examples

1. She spent **half of her salary** on rent.

她把薪金的**一半**花在租金上。

2. We used **half of the paper**.

我們用了紙張的**一半**。

Determiner use

4. half + noun

= fifty percent of a quantity, time, group, etc.

一半的.....

Examples

1. **Half the class** passed the test.

全班一半通過了測驗。

2. I waited **half an hour**.

我等了**半小時**。

5. half an hour / half a day / half a year

= one-half of a unit of time

半小時 / 半天 / 半年

Examples

1. The journey took **half an hour**.

路程花了**半小時**。

2. She stayed there for **half a year**.

她在那裡住了**半年**。

Adverb: partly / incompletely

6. half — partly

= partly, but not completely

半；部分地；有點

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. I was only **half listening**.

我只是**一半在聽 / 沒完全專心聽**。

2. The door was **half open**.

門**半開著**。

7. half joking / half serious

= partly joking and partly serious

半開玩笑 / 半認真

Examples

1. She was **half joking** when she said she might move abroad.

她說可能搬到海外時是**半開玩笑的**。

2. His comment was **half serious**.

他的評論是**半認真的**。

8. half asleep / half awake

= not completely asleep or awake

半睡半醒；睡眠惺忪

Examples

1. I was still **half asleep** when the phone rang.

電話響時我還**半睡半醒**。

2. He lay there **half awake**.

他躺在那裡，處於**半清醒狀態**。

Physical division

9. half — one side / one part of a divided object

= one of two sections into which something is divided

半邊；一半

Examples

1. Cut the apple into two **halves**.

把蘋果切成兩**半**。

2. One **half** of the room was painted blue.

房間的—**半**漆成藍色。

Sport

10. half — one of two periods in a game

= either of the two main periods of a sports match

上半場 / 下半場中的一半；半場

Examples

1. They scored twice in the first **half**.

他們在**上半場**進了兩球。

2. The second **half** was much more exciting.

下半場精彩得多。

11. half-time

= break between the two halves of a match

中場休息

Examples

1. The score was 1–1 at **half-time**.
中場休息時比分是一比一。
2. The coach changed tactics at **half-time**.
教練在**中場休息**時改變戰術。

Relationship / family

12. half brother / half sister

= sibling who shares only one biological parent with you
同父異母 / 同母異父的兄弟姊妹

Examples

1. He has a **half brother** in Canada.
他在加拿大有一位**同父異母 / 同母異父的兄弟**。
2. She grew up with her **half sister**.
她和自己的**同父異母 / 同母異父姊妹**一起長大。

Reduced degree / partial quality

13. half-hearted

= lacking enthusiasm, effort, or commitment
敷衍的；三心兩意的；不投入的

Examples

1. He made a **half-hearted attempt** to apologize.
他**敷衍地**試著道歉。
2. Her support sounded **half-hearted**.
她的支持聽起來**不太真心**。

14. half-baked

= poorly thought out or not fully developed

考慮不周的；不成熟的

Examples

1. It was a **half-baked idea**.

那是個**不成熟的想法**。

2. The proposal seemed **half-baked**.

那項提議似乎**考慮得不夠周全**。

Informal.

Approximate / not fully

15. half-decent / half-good / half-reasonable

Informal pattern:

= reasonably, but not especially, good/decent/etc.

還算.....；勉強算.....

Examples

1. We finally found a **half-decent restaurant**.

我們終於找到一家**還算不錯的餐廳**。

2. He gave a **half-reasonable explanation**.

他給了一個**勉強說得過去的解釋**。

This use is productive but informal.

Noun: person / member in a pair

16. better half

= humorous/affectionate term for one's spouse or partner

另一半；伴侶

Examples

1. I'm travelling with my **better half**.

我會和我的**另一半**一起旅行。

2. She introduced me to her **better half**.

她把她的**伴侶**介紹給我。

17. other half

A. remaining half of something

另一半

1. I ate one half and saved the **other half**.

我吃了一半，留下**另一半**。

B. partner/spouse

另一半；伴侶

2. He came with his **other half**.

他和自己的**另一半**一起來。

Compounds / lexicalized uses

18. halfway

A. at the middle point

在中途；到一半

1. We stopped **halfway** up the hill.

我們走到山的**半途**停下來。

B. partly / incompletely

部分地；不完全地

2. The job is only **halfway finished**.

工作只完成了**一半左右**。

19. halfway house

A. temporary residential facility between institutional care and independent living

中途之家

B. figuratively, compromise between two extremes

折衷方案；中間狀態

Examples

1. He stayed in a **halfway house** after leaving prison.
他離開監獄後住進了**中途之家**。
2. The plan is a **halfway house** between the two proposals.
這個方案是兩個提議之間的**折衷方案**。

20. half-price

= costing 50% of the normal price

半價

Examples

1. Tickets are **half-price** today.
今天門票**半價**。
2. I bought the coat at **half price**.
我用**半價**買了那件外套。

21. half-day

= period lasting half a normal working/school day

半天

Examples

1. We had a **half-day** at school.
我們今天只上**半天課**。
2. She took a **half-day** off.
她請了**半天假**。

Fixed expressions

22. not half

Especially BrE informal:

= very; extremely, often in expressions like “not half bad”

非常；很

Examples

1. That meal was **not half bad**.

那頓飯**相當不錯**。

2. He's **not half clever**.

他**真的很聰明**。

This is idiomatic and does not literally mean 50%.

23. not half as...as

= much less than

遠沒有.....那麼.....

Examples

1. The test was **not half as difficult as** I expected.

測驗**遠沒有我想像中那麼難**。

2. This bag is **not half as heavy as** that one.

這個袋子**遠沒有那個那麼重**。

24. half the battle

= a major part of what is needed for success

成功的一大半；關鍵的一步

Examples

1. Knowing what the problem is is **half the battle**.

知道問題所在已經是**成功的一大半**。

2. Getting started is **half the battle**.

願意開始就是**最關鍵的一步之一**。

25. half and half

= equal mixture or division of two things

一半一半；各半

Examples

1. The drink is **half coffee and half milk**.

這杯飲料是**一半咖啡、一半牛奶**。

2. We split the cost **half and half**.

我們把費用**一人一半**。

26. by half

Mostly in comparative constructions:

= by a considerable amount

大大地；遠遠地

Examples

1. The task was too difficult **by half**.

那項任務實在**太難了**。

2. The room was too small **by half**.

那個房間**小得太多了**。

Somewhat literary/old-fashioned.

27. half measures

= incomplete or insufficient actions

半吊子的措施；不徹底的做法

Examples

1. This problem cannot be solved with **half measures**.

這個問題不能靠**不徹底的措施**解決。

2. We need a real solution, not **half measures**.

我們需要真正的解決方案，不要**半吊子的做法**。

28. do something by halves

= do something incompletely or without full effort

做事不徹底；只做一半

Usually in the negative:

> **never do things by halves**

= do things fully and enthusiastically

做事從不半途而廢 / 總是全力以赴

Examples

1. She never **does things by halves**.

她做事從不**敷衍了事**。

2. If he starts a project, he doesn't **do it by halves**.

他一旦開始專案，就不會**只做到一半**。

Related forms

29. halve

= divide something into two equal parts, or reduce by 50%

把.....減半；平分成兩半

Examples

1. **Halve the apple**.

把蘋果**切成兩半**。

2. The company **halved its costs**.

公司把成本**減半**。

30. halved

= divided or reduced by half

減半的；分成兩半的

Examples

1. The price was **halved**.

價格**減半了**。

2. The fruit was **halved** before serving.

水果上桌前被**切成兩半**。

Key contrasts

31. half vs partly

half

can literally mean 50%, but as an adverb it may also loosely mean “partly.”

partly

= to some degree, not completely

部分地

Compare:

> the glass is **half full**

> 杯子半滿

> I was **partly responsible**

> 我負有部分責任

In **half joking**, the meaning is not necessarily mathematically 50%.

32. half vs semi-

half

= one of two equal parts, or partly

****semi-****

= prefix meaning partly, half, or occurring twice within a larger unit depending on word

****半 ; 部分****

Examples:

> semicircle

> 半圓

> semi-formal

> 半正式

They are not freely interchangeable.

33. half vs halfway

****half****

= quantity or degree

****halfway****

= at or to the middle point, literally or figuratively

Compare:

> half the journey

> 一半路程

> halfway through the journey

> 走到旅程中途

34. half vs almost

****half****

= partly

****almost****

= nearly but not completely

****幾乎****

Compare:

> half asleep

> 半睡半醒

> almost asleep

> 幾乎睡著了

These are not the same.

Meaning map

The central concept of **half** is:

one of two equal parts

From this develop:

Quantity

half the cake

→ **一半**

Time

half an hour

→ **半小時**

Partial state

half asleep

→ **半睡半醒**

Passage use

half joking

→ **半開玩笑**

Sport

first half

→ **上半場**

Family relation

half sister

→ **同父異母 / 同母異父姊妹**

Reduced commitment

half-hearted

→ **敷衍的**

Incomplete idea

half-baked

→ **不成熟的**

Progress

halfway

→ **中途 / 到一半**

Division

halve

→ **減半 / 平分**

The passage uses the **partial-degree adverbial** branch:

> **half joking and half serious**

> → **半開玩笑、半認真**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
half — one of two equal parts	整體的二分之一；一半
half of something	某物的一半
half + noun	一半的某物 / 某段時間
half an hour/day/year	半小時 / 半天 / 半年
half — partly	只到某種程度、並非完全；半 / 部分地
half joking / half serious	半開玩笑 / 半認真
half asleep / awake	半睡半醒 / 半清醒
half — physical division	被分成兩部分後的其中一半
half — sport	球賽兩個主要時段中的一個；半場
half-time	上下半場之間的中場休息
half brother/sister	只共有一名親生父母的兄弟姊妹
half-hearted	缺乏熱情、投入或誠意的；敷衍的
half-baked	想法或計畫尚未成熟、考慮不周的

better half	幽默 / 親暱地指伴侶、另一半	
other half	剩下的一半；也可指伴侶	
halfway — position	到中途 / 中間位置	
halfway — degree	只完成或達到部分程度	
halfway house	中途之家；比喻兩種極端之間的折衷方案	
half-price	正常價格的一半；半價	
half-day	半天；半日工作 / 上課	
not half bad	英式非正式：其實相當不錯	
not half as...as	遠沒有.....那麼.....	
half the battle	成功所需的一大部分；關鍵一步	
half and half	兩部分比例各半；一半一半	
half measures	不完整、不徹底的措施	
do something by halves	做事不徹底，只投入部分努力	
halve	把某物分成兩半或減少 50%	

Passage recap

> “... ****half joking and half serious****...”

Here:

****half**** = ****partly; to some extent, but not completely****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****半****

* ****部分地****

* contextually: ****半開玩笑、半認真****

Natural contextual translation:

****她當時半開玩笑、半認真地對我說.....****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****half****

= ****partly or to some extent, rather than completely****

****半；部分地****

The crucial point is that this use is ****not mathematical****.

> ****half the cake****

> → exactly one-half

but:

> ****half joking****

> → partly joking, not necessarily exactly 50%

So in the passage, the sister is being playful, but there is also a genuine message behind what she says.